

GALACTIC EMPIRE MILITARY OOB

Imperial Military Structure & Order of Battle

Sources: Imperial Handbook (primary) · Essential Guide to Warfare · The Rebel Files
Galactic Civil War — 2 BBY

SOURCE PRIORITY: The Imperial Handbook (canon, 2014) is the primary source for all military structure, ranks, and doctrine. Essential Guide to Warfare (2012) provides strategic context and command hierarchy. The Rebel Files provides supplementary intel assessments from the Alliance perspective.

PART I — IMPERIAL COMMAND STRUCTURE

SOURCE: *Imperial Handbook* (Yularen/Tagge), *Essential Guide to Warfare*

The Galactic Empire is a strict top-down hierarchy. All military authority flows from the Emperor through a clearly defined chain of command. There are no ambiguities, no democratic processes, and no legislative overrides. Coordination is enforced rather than negotiated.

Supreme Command

Position	Title	Notes
Emperor Palpatine	Supreme Commander	Absolute authority over all Imperial military forces. Answers to no one. All Moffs, Grand Moffs, Admirals, and Generals ultimately serve at his pleasure.
Darth Vader	Supreme Commander's enforcer / Dark Lord	Operates outside normal chain of command. Can supersede any officer of any rank. Direct representative of the Emperor's will.
Imperial Ruling Council	Advisory body	Senior advisors to the Emperor. Limited direct military authority but significant political influence over military appointments.

Regional Governance — The Moff System

SOURCE: *Essential Guide to Warfare*, *The Rebel Files*

The Empire is divided into sectors, each governed by a Moff. Sectors with active military campaigns or special projects are elevated to Oversectors and governed by Grand Moffs with expanded military authority. This system was formalized by Wilhuff Tarkin's proposal and accepted by the Emperor.

Rank	Title	Territory	Military Authority
Emperor	Supreme Commander	Galaxy	Absolute. All Imperial military forces.
Grand Moff	Oversector Governor	Multiple sectors (Oversector / Priority Sector)	Commands all naval and ground forces within oversector. Also commands special projects (Death Star). Tarkin held Greater Seswenna Oversector.
Moff	Sector Governor	Single sector	Commands all military forces within sector. Commands the Sector Group (naval) and Sector Army (ground).
Regional Governor	System/Planetary Governor	Star system or single planet	Commands local garrison. Reports to Moff. No independent military command authority beyond garrison.

ISB Director	Imperial Security Bureau	Galaxy-wide	Parallel intelligence and enforcement structure. Operates independently of military chain of command. Answers directly to the Emperor through COMPNOR.
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PART II — IMPERIAL NAVY

SOURCE: *Imperial Handbook Part II (Admiral Yularen), Essential Guide to Warfare*

Motto: Service, Fealty, Fidelity. The goal of the Imperial Navy is absolute dominance of known space. Naval Command responds directly to the Emperor's orders. The Navy has four branches: Line Branch (warships), Flight Branch (starfighters), Fleet Support Branch (maintenance/engineering), and Support Service Branch (communications, navigation, weapons, medical).

Naval Officer Rank Insignia

SOURCE: *Imperial Handbook — Naval Officer Rank Insignia*

Rank	Insignia	Description
Midshipman	Two squares	Lowest officer position in the Imperial Navy.
Lieutenant	Four squares, one code cylinder	Encompasses Junior Lieutenant, Senior Lieutenant, and Junior Commander. Most officers aboard ship hold this position.
Captain	Six squares, one code cylinder	Commanding officer of a ship. Includes line rank of Senior Commander.
Admiral	Eight squares, two code cylinders	Equivalent to Commodore. Informally addressed as Commander. Commands a squadron.
Fleet Admiral	Ten squares, three code cylinders	Commander of a fleet, or top military official within a planetary sector.
High Admiral / Grand Admiral	Twelve squares, four code cylinders	Elite rank held only by those personally promoted by Emperor Palpatine. Grand Admirals wear distinctive white dress uniforms with gold epaulets. There are only twelve Grand Admirals.

Naval Uniforms

Uniform	Color	Who Wears It
Naval Officer uniform	Gray-green tunic	Standard officers. Double-breasted tunic, trousers, cap. Rank plaque on chest.
Grand Admiral uniform	White with gold epaulets	Only Grand Admirals. Personally authorized by Emperor.
Naval Trooper uniform	All-black jumpsuit	Naval troopers — security duties and direct combat. Not officers. Used extensively on Star Destroyers and Death Star.

Fleet Structure & Organization

SOURCE: *Imperial Handbook — Structure and Organization*

Unit	Composition	Commander	Notes
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Line	Typically 4 larger ships (up to 20)	Captain of the Line	Smallest organizational unit for space combat. Types: Attack Line (3 heavy cruisers), Heavy Attack Line (4-8 heavy cruisers), Star Destroyer Line (single ISD — equivalent to a full line), Skirmish Line (4-20 corvettes), Pursuit Line (4-10 light cruisers/frigates), Troop Line (2 assault transports + 2 medium cruisers), Recon Line (2-4 light cruisers with surveillance gear).
Squadron	Multiple lines, 14-60 ships total	Admiral	Standard unit assigned to a single star system. Types: Light Squadron (1 skirmish line + 1 recon line, low-threat systems), standard and battle squadrons for higher-threat systems.
Fleet	Multiple squadrons, up to 400 ships	Admiral (also titled Commodore)	Operates within a single sector but does not represent all of a sector's naval resources. Types: Superiority Fleet (6 ISDs + up to 400 support ships), Assault Fleet (transport + escort forces), Bombard Fleet (system bombards + escorts), Support Fleet (500 small vessels, container ships), Deepdock Fleet (280 support vessels + shipyard support).
Sector Group	Multiple fleets, min. 2,400 ships (at least 24 Star Destroyers)	High Admiral or Sector Moff	Total naval forces within a sector. Sector Groups can be assembled into Regional Groups or Oversector Groups but these are not part of standard Order of Battle.

Key Capital Ships (2 BBY)

Ship	Class	Length	Notes
Imperial-class Star Destroyer (ISD-I)	Capital ship / Star Destroyer Line	1,600 m	Primary Imperial warship. By itself equals a full line. Crew of 37,000+. Carries TIE fighters and AT-ATs. The face of Imperial naval power.
Victory-class Star Destroyer (VSD)	Capital ship	900 m	Older design, operates well inside planetary atmospheres. Noticeably slower than ISD at sublight. Still in service at 2 BBY.
Interdictor Cruiser	Cruiser / gravity well projector	600 m	Projects gravity wells to prevent hyperspace escape. Most common is Immobilizer 418. Critical for cutting off Rebel retreat routes.
Super Star Destroyer (SSD)	Dreadnought	19,000 m	Not yet in service at 2 BBY (in construction at Kuat Drive Yards). Crew of 280,000+. Over 5,000 turbolaser and ion cannon batteries.

Sentinel-class landing craft	Troop transport	38 m	Standard heavy transport. Carries 54 troopers with speeder bikes and heavy equipment, or up to 12 AT-ST walkers in reconfigured cargo compartment.
Y-85 Titan dropship	Walker transport	—	Deploys AT-AT walkers from naval warships to planetary surfaces. Heavy armor for sustained fire during descent.

PART III — IMPERIAL ARMY

SOURCE: Imperial Handbook Part III (High General Cassio Tagge)

The goal of the Imperial Army is surface superiority. The Army captures and occupies worlds in the name of the Emperor and defends them from aggression. "The Imperial Army, and only the Imperial Army, is equipped to seize and defend a planet." — High General Tagge

The Army encompasses infantry, armored cavalry, special forces, artillery operators, engineers, scouts, and drivers. It is NOT the Stormtrooper Corps — the two branches are separate and distinct.

Army Unit Structure

SOURCE: Imperial Handbook — Formations and Deployment

Unit	Commander	Size	Capable Of	Notes
Squad	Sergeant	9 troopers (8 + Sergeant)	Capturing a building	Smallest Army unit. Subdivides into two fire teams. Types: Line Squad (basic infantry), Heavy Weapons Squad (repeating blasters), Sharpshooter Squad (snipers, drawn from Special Missions), Engineering Squad (demolitions/repair), Repulsorlift Squad (2 light repulsorlift transports), Scout Squad/Lance (5 troopers, speeder bikes or AT-RTs).
Platoon	Lieutenant	4 squads	Capturing a district	Cross-attached for missions. Types: Line Platoon (4 infantry squads), Assault Platoon (2 line + 2 HWS squads, can be augmented with armored vehicles), Artillery Platoon (4 artillery pieces or 8 artillery vehicles), Armor Platoon (4 AT-ATs or 8 repulsortanks), Repulsorlift Platoon (4 repulsorlift squads), Heavy Weapons Repulsorlift Platoon (4 HWS repulsorlift squads), Scout Platoon (2 scout lances + 2 infantry squads), Special Missions Platoon (variable — typically 2 sharpshooter + 1 engineering + 1 HWS squads).
Company	Captain	4 platoons	Capturing a city	Large enough to require support personnel including logistics, medical, and technical. Also employs military-issue droids. Types: Line Company (standard infantry), plus various specialized companies.
Battalion	Major or Lt. Colonel	4 companies	Capturing a region	Standard tactical unit for large-scale ground operations.
Regiment	Colonel	4 battalions	Capturing a continent	Administrative and operational unit. Imperial Army regiments number in the thousands.
Sector Army	High General	Multiple corps	Controlling a sector	The largest ground formation. Each sector has a Sector Army. The Sector Army answers to the Moff. Total ~150,000 troopers per Sector Army at full strength (inherited from Clone Wars structure).

Imperial Army Officer Uniforms

SOURCE: *Imperial Handbook*, *Andor* (canon TV), *The Rebel Files*

Uniform	Color	Who Wears It
Stormtrooper Corps officer	Black tunic	Officers commanding Stormtrooper units. Confirmed by Andor and recent canon. The "black hat" look associated with Imperial officers commanding Stormtroopers.
Imperial Army officer	Grey/olive tunic	Officers commanding regular Imperial Army infantry. The classic Grand Moff / Admiral grey uniform.
ISB officer	White tunic	Imperial Security Bureau agents. White is distinct from both military branches.
Planetary Governor staff	Grey/olive or black tunic	Varies by posting. Army-adjacent officers typically grey, Stormtrooper-adjacent black.

Key Ground Vehicles

Vehicle	Type	Crew / Capacity	Notes
AT-AT Walker	Heavy assault walker	Crew: 5 + 40 troops	Primary planetary assault vehicle. 22.5 meters tall. Four heavy laser cannons, two medium repeating blasters. Extremely difficult to destroy frontally. Weak at ankle joints.
AT-ST Scout Walker	Light reconnaissance walker	Crew: 2	Fast and maneuverable. Two chin-mounted laser cannons, one concussion grenade launcher, one blaster cannon. Used for reconnaissance, perimeter patrol, and infantry support.
74-Z Speeder Bike	Reconnaissance bike	Crew: 1	Primary repulsorlift craft operated by Imperial scouts. Single forward-facing blaster cannon. Max speed over 500 km/hr. Operated by Scout Troopers.
BARC Speeder	Reconnaissance bike	Crew: 1	Older model still in wide use. Two front blaster cannons, two rear. Reliable and virtually maintenance-free. Many scout units prefer it to the 74-Z.
Imperial Troop Transport (ITT)	Ground troop transport	Crew: 2 + 10 troops	Standard surface troop carrier. Used for prisoner transport and garrison duty.

PART IV — IMPERIAL STORMTROOPER CORPS

SOURCE: *Imperial Handbook Part IV, The Rebel Files* (Melshi assessment)

"Stormtroopers are the knife's edge. We are the first to go in. We face the enemy when they are strongest. We do not stop until we have achieved our objective. The Imperial Army walks in the path we blaze." — Imperial Handbook

The Stormtrooper Corps is independent of the Imperial Army. It operates jointly with both Army and Navy as needed, but answers to its own command structure. It is unconcerned with long-term occupation — it deploys when the Emperor requires and is recalled when needed elsewhere.

At 2 BBY the Corps uses human recruits meeting strict physical and psychological requirements (97.5% genetic match to clone template, 1.79–1.85m height, 78–85kg weight). Cloning was phased out under Commandant Cumberlayne Aresko's recruitment reforms.

Stormtrooper Specializations

SOURCE: *Imperial Handbook* — *Stormtrooper Specializations*

Specialization	Environment	Distinctive Equipment	Notes
Standard Stormtrooper	All environments	E-11 blaster rifle, thermal detonator, standard 18-piece plastoid armor	Core unit. Squad of 9: 1 Sergeant, remainder privates/specialists. Two fire teams per squad.
Scout Trooper	Reconnaissance / all terrain	74-Z speeder bike, lightweight nonrestrictive armor, DLT-19X sniper rifle	Specialists in mobile reconnaissance. Lighter armor for speed. Biker scouts.
Cold Assault Stormtrooper (Snowtrooper)	Frozen/arctic worlds	Breather hood, E-11, survival kit, terrain grip boots	Operates in temperatures as low as −100 degrees. Trained as survivalists. Breather hood recirculates warm air.
Desert Assault Stormtrooper (Sandtrooper)	Hot, dry, desert, ash	E-11, cooling recirculators, breathing filters, additional armor plates	Stationed on hot dry worlds. Armor cooling systems and breathing filters for sand/ash environments. Can be deployed in hot tropical environments.
Aquatic Assault Stormtrooper (Seatrooper)	Oceanic/underwater	Modified E-11 (doubles as speargun), flippered boots, backpack propulsion, AT-AT Swimmer	Air supply lasts over one hour. Armor resists crushing ocean depths. Ferried by AT-AT Swimmers or waveskimmers.
Bomb Squad Stormtrooper (Bombtrooper)	All environments / EOD	Sensor helmet, shrapnel-resistant armor, E-11	Trained to disarm explosive devices. Can recover intact devices for Imperial Intelligence — superior to bomb-disposal droids for this purpose.

Death Trooper	All environments / Special Ops	E-11D blaster carbine, DLT-19D marksman rifle, black armor coated with sensor-warping material	Extremely rare. Serve Imperial Intelligence as bodyguards and special-missions experts. Black armor warps electronic signals to hide from sensor sweeps. Body augmentations. — Rebel Files: "Two platoons" referenced at one training camp.
SCAR Trooper (Task Force 99)	All environments / Elite Commando	Varies by mission — standard Stormtrooper kit plus specialized equipment	Special Commando Advanced Recon Trooper. Elite stormtroopers with unusual degree of autonomy. Deployed in small squads led by sergeant. Answer to highest echelons of Imperial command. — Rebel Files intelligence assessment.

Standard Stormtrooper Weapons

Weapon	Type	Notes
E-11 blaster rifle	Standard issue blaster	Primary weapon of all standard Stormtroopers. Range up to 300 meters. Light enough for one-hand operation. Known for reliability in harsh conditions.
E-Web Heavy Repeating Blaster	Crew-served heavy weapon	BlasTech E-Web. Maximum range 750 meters. Anti-infantry and armor-penetrating settings. Operated by two Stormtroopers. Assembled in under one minute. Generator takes up to 10 minutes to reach full power.
Thermal detonator	Anti-personnel / explosive	Cylindrical, baradium core. Blast radius 5 meters. Time delay 6-18 seconds. Security lockout — each trooper issued unique access code at mission start to prevent enemy arming.
DLT-19 heavy blaster rifle	Heavy support	Longer range than E-11. Used by Stormtrooper heavy weapons troopers. Sustained fire capability.
SE-14r light repeating blaster	Officer sidearm	Standard sidearm for Stormtrooper Corps officers.
74-Z speeder bike cannon	Vehicle-mounted	Single forward-facing blaster cannon. Part of Scout Trooper standard kit.

PART V — IMPERIAL INTELLIGENCE & ISB

SOURCE: *Imperial Handbook* (Yularen), *The Rebel Files*

Organization	Head (2 BBY)	Function	Notes
Imperial Intelligence (Ubiqtorate)	Various — compartmentalized	Strategic intelligence gathering. Enemy force composition and strength. Covert operations. Predecessor was Republic Intelligence.	Advanced work collected before any battle can be launched. Stays away from front lines. Provides intelligence that informs every command decision.
Imperial Security Bureau (ISB)	ISB Director	Internal security. Loyalty enforcement. Counter-insurgency. Political surveillance. Parallel structure to military.	Operates independently of military chain of command. Answers directly to Emperor through COMPNOR. ISB agents embedded in every major Imperial installation. Notorious for arresting officers suspected of disloyalty. — Rebel Files: Tarkin Initiative fell under ISB's Advanced Weapons Research division.
COMPNOR	Emperor's advisors	Commission for the Preservation of the New Order. Oversees arts, education, propaganda, HoloNet access restrictions. Umbrella organization for ISB.	Controls information across the Empire. HoloNet access restricted through COMPNOR channels. Propaganda arm ensures citizens receive approved Imperial messaging.
Death Squadron (Special)	Darth Vader	Vader's personal fleet. Hunts Rebel leadership, eliminates key targets, enforces Imperial will in the Outer Rim.	Flagship: Executor (pre-Endor). Death Squadron leaves a trail of destroyed Rebel cells. — Essential Guide: "In every sector, Death Squadron left a trail of destroyed outposts and executed regional governors." Reduced to 12 Star Destroyers by end of Galactic Civil War.

The Tarkin Doctrine

SOURCE: *The Rebel Files* (Alliance Intelligence Assessment)

A political philosophy with three platforms: (1) territorial consolidation — the Empire controls space, not just planets; (2) centralized control of information — the HoloNet and all comms are Imperial assets; (3) governing through fear — the Death Star project is the physical embodiment of this third point. Rule through the threat of annihilation rather than through overwhelming military presence everywhere at once.

ALLIANCE ASSESSMENT: "The Tarkin Doctrine works until it doesn't. Fear requires the capacity to follow through. The moment the Empire fails to destroy something it has threatened to destroy, the doctrine collapses. This is the strategic logic behind Yavin." — Alliance High Command internal document

PART VI — IMPERIAL FORCE COMPOSITION FOR CAMPAIGN USE

How to apply this structure to the Sector Command campaign at 2 BBY.

Imperial Ground Force Types

Force Type	App Tag	Composition	Typical Size	Notes
Imperial Army Garrison	IMP_GARRISON	Imperial Army line infantry. Grey/olive uniforms. Standard weapons.	100-2,000+	Primary occupation force. Holds sectors. Mans checkpoints. Handles day-to-day Imperial control.
Imperial Army Line Company	IMP_LINE_CPY	4 platoons of Army infantry + Captain + HQ element.	~152 men	Standard deployable Army unit. Capable of capturing a city. Per handbook: Squad (9) Platoon (4 squads) Company (4 platoons).
Stormtrooper Detachment	IMP_ST_DET	Elite Stormtrooper unit attached to Army operation. Black-tuniced officers.	38-160 men	First-strike element. Leads assaults, clears beachheads. Recalled after objective. Does NOT garrison.
Scout Trooper Unit	IMP_SCOUT	Scout Troopers on 74-Z speeder bikes. Reconnaissance.	9-36 men	Fast flanking and pursuit. Eyes of the Army in the field.
Death Troopers	IMP_DEATH	Elite special operations. Black armor. Serve Imperial Intelligence.	4-12 men	Only present if a high-value target is the objective. Capture/assassination mission indicator.
AT-AT Complement	IMP_ATAT	Heavy walkers + Stormtrooper passengers.	1-8 walkers	Planetary assault spearhead. Shock and awe. Extremely difficult to destroy frontally.

Imperial Naval Force Types in Campaign

Force Type	App Tag	Composition	Notes
Sector Squadron	IMP_SEC_SQD	~14-60 ships. Admiral commanding. Assigned to one star system.	Standard system-level naval presence. Has enough firepower to destroy Rebel cells and blockade planets.
Sector Fleet	IMP_SEC_FLT	Up to 400 ships. Admiral/Commodore commanding. Operates within single sector.	Full sector naval resources. Includes Superiority Fleet, Assault Fleet, and support elements.

Death Squadron	IMP_DEATH_S QD	Vader's personal fleet. Multiple ISDs + Executor (post-construction). Operates galaxy-wide.	Not sector-bound. Appears anywhere the Emperor directs. Represents existential threat level for Rebel cells.
Planetary Blockade Line	IMP_BLOCKAD E	1-4 Star Destroyers + support ships encircling a planet.	Prevents Rebel resupply and escape. Interdictors added to prevent hyperspace jumps.

Deployment Rules for 2 BBY

Situation	Imperial Force Composition
Imperial-controlled sector (peaceful)	Army garrison only. Moff governing. Local ISB presence. No major fleet — just a Sector Squadron for system control.
Imperial-controlled sector (insurgency active)	Reinforced Army garrison + Stormtrooper detachment for aggressive operations. ISB actively hunting cell leadership. Fleet blockading key supply worlds.
Contested sector	Full Army deployment + multiple Stormtrooper companies. Assault Fleet in orbit ready to land reinforcements. Possible Interdictor deployment to prevent Rebel resupply.
Planetary assault operation	Assault Fleet in orbit. AT-AT complement landing via Y-85 Titan dropships. Stormtroopers spearheading with Army following. Scout Troopers flanking. Death Troopers if HVT present.
Sector commander present (Tarkin/Thrawn type)	Full Sector Group (min. 24 Star Destroyers). All ground forces at full readiness. ISB subordinated to commander's direct authority. Death Squadron may be present.
ISB operation	Small Army escort only. ISB agents primary. May not even involve Stormtroopers. Operates in plain clothes or officer uniform. Loyalty investigations, arrests, interrogations.

KEY DOCTRINE: The Tarkin Doctrine says govern through fear, not through military presence everywhere. The Imperial Army holds ground. Stormtroopers strike and move on. The Navy controls space. Fear — not bodies — enforces compliance. When fear fails, overwhelming force follows.